

```

Password inactive          :
never
Account expires           :
never
Minimum number of days between password change      :
0
Maximum number of days between password change      :
99999
Number of days of warning before password expires   :
7

```

To set any of these values, simply use the following syntax, and follow the interactive prompts:

```
sudo chage username
```

The following is also an example of how you can manually change the explicit expiration date (-E) to 03/31/2010, minimum password age (-m) of 5 days, maximum password age (-M) of 90 days, inactivity period (-I) of 5 days after password expiration, and a warning time period (-W) of 14 days before password expiration.

```
sudo chage -E 03/31/2010 -m 5 -M 90 -I 30 -W 14 username
```

To verify changes, use the same syntax as mentioned previously:

```
sudo chage -l username
```

The output below shows the new policies that have been established for the account:

```

Last password change          : Mar 20, 2010
Password expires              : Jun 19, 2010
Password inactive             : Aug 19, 2010
Account expires               : Jan 31, 2010
Minimum number of days between password change      : 5
Maximum number of days between password change      : 90
Number of days of warning before password expires   : 14

```

Other Security Considerations

Many applications use alternate authentication mechanisms that can be easily overlooked by even experienced system administrators. Therefore, it is important to understand and control how users authenticate and gain access to services and applications on your server.

SSH Access by Disabled Users

Simply disabling/locking a user account will not prevent a user from logging into your server remotely if they have previously set up RSA public key authentication. They will still be able to gain shell access to the server, without the need for any password. Remember to check the users home